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ASIA'S MEDITERRANEAN

Strategy, Geopolitics, and Risk in the Seas of the Indo-Pacific

I.

"I believe China seeks hegemony in East Asia."[1]

The statement, delivered in congressional testimony by the then commander of US Pacific Command in February 2016, was shockingly blunt by official standards.[2] US policy toward China since the opening of bilateral relations in the 1970s has been predicated on incorporating China into the liberal global order and creating a cooperative relationship of trust between the two nations. For years, media reports, books, and scholarly studies had approvingly talked about China's unprecedented modernization, while high-level US government officials repeated their hopes that Beijing would eventually become a pillar of the international order, sharing with America the burden of maintaining the post–World War II system.

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